Option Two: where we are

The Sales and Data Brain - all 54 automations, checked against what's built in BMI Brain. 29 October 2026.

BMI Publishing
LEADING THE WAY IN TRAVEL

35	9	10	54
Done	Partly done	Not started	In Option Two

Also done, from Option Two's foundations: the move off Act! (your history brought across and running alongside Act!; a final fresh copy is loaded at go-live) and the Ask the Brain chat over clients, bookings and figures.

Customer and circulation data

14 automations · 9 done · 3 partly · 2 not started

ID	Automation	Status	Notes
CS-001	Bounce classification and processing	Done	Bounces in the sending inboxes are read and the contact is updated, after review.
CS-002	Out-of-office replacement mining	Done	Auto-replies are read for a named alternative, successor or leaving date.
CS-003	Departure detection and successor finding	Done	Leavers are detected from auto-replies and their record updated, with the successor taken from the reply.
CS-004	Duplicate and moved-person merging	Done	Duplicates and people at a new company are found and merged after review.
CS-005	Returned copy processing	Done	Photos of returned labels are read and matched to the contact.
CS-006	Email list validation before sending	Partly done	Mail merge and Copy emails leave out unsubscribed, bounced and duplicate addresses. No syntax, domain or mailbox check yet.
CS-007	Attendee list import and cross-checking	Done	Contact import (Excel, CSV, PDF) matches every row to the database and shows who's new and who's already there.
CS-008	Proactive audience sourcing	Not started	
CS-009	Location-targeted event audiences	Partly done	Advanced search selects by town, postcode or country and saves a group. No automatic "within reach of the venue".
CS-010	Shared enquiries inbox routing	Partly done	Shared inboxes are scanned for new contacts, proposal requests, subscription changes and press releases. Sorting one mixed inbox into all of these, and invitations, isn't built.
CS-011	Editor inbox pre-sorting	Not started	

CS-012	Registration validation and reader queries	Done	Every sign-up from the subscribe forms is checked for missing details, addresses that don't add up, people already on the database and personal email addresses. Live once Clare connects the forms (OBH digital by email, as its form can't send direct).
CS-013	Subscription change processing	Done	Emails to the subscriptions inbox become a card with the change ready to make: unsubscribe, subscribe, new address or new details, recorded on the contact. Reader questions get a reply drafted. Unsubscribes are made in Brevo too, and Brevo's own unsubscribes come back, once its key is on the server.
CS-014	Overseas subscription handling	Done	Overseas sign-ups asking for print (Selling Travel and TBTM) get a reply drafted offering the digital edition, sent from the reviewer's Outlook.

The sales engine

32 automations · 20 done · 4 partly · 8 not started

ID	Automation	Status	Notes
SALES-001	Business card reading	Done	Photos of one or several cards are read into contacts.
SALES-002	Card de-duplication and group assignment	Done	Each card is checked against the database, with groups suggested.
SALES-003	New issue page links to advertisers	Partly done	New issues on BMI's Issuu page are matched to their issue, and each salesperson gets a "your advert is live" note for their advertisers, with the link. It links to the issue; each advertiser's own page needs the page their advert is on.
SALES-004	Coverage forwarding to featured clients	Partly done	Clients named in the newsletters sent from Brevo get a "you're in our newsletter" note drafted for their salesperson. Website stories aren't read yet. Live once Brevo's key is on the server.
SALES-005	Personal touchpoint reminders	Done	
SALES-006	Competitor advertiser identification	Not started	
SALES-007	Advertiser gap analysis and approach drafting	Not started	
SALES-008	Call note capture	Done	The notetaker joins calls (from a link or the calendar) and saves the notes to the client. Zoom calls start once Zoom approves the app.
SALES-009	Proposal logging	Done	
SALES-010	Email exchange summarising	Done	
SALES-011	Inbound contact capture	Done	
SALES-012	Budget window and renewal triggers	Done	
SALES-013	Morning follow-up queue with drafts	Done	

SALES-014	Press release parsing and contact identification	Done	Releases the editors forward are read for the company, the story and everyone to contact, matched to the CRM; marketing and trade contacts come before the press office.
SALES-015	Media kit outreach drafting	Done	Each release comes with a short introduction drafted (the story, the media pack link, an offer to talk), sent from the publisher's Outlook.
SALES-016	Right-person identification at target companies	Not started	
SALES-017	LinkedIn profile to email enrichment	Not started	
SALES-018	Email verification and traffic-light grading	Not started	
SALES-019	Verified contact loading	Not started	
SALES-020	Tailored proposal assembly	Done	From the client's history, the editorial plan and the rate card, in BMI's templates. Learns each person's writing style; BMI's voice improves with 3-5 sent proposals.
SALES-021	Renewal outreach with previous placements	Done	Quotes last year's booking and this year's price, and links to last year's issue once its online link is added.
SALES-022	Template library and save-the-sale responses	Done	
SALES-023	Meeting notes to pitch	Done	Notes from a client meeting turned into a tailored pitch, from the call notes the notetaker saves.
SALES-024	Per-project prospect pipeline	Not started	On hold while BMI discusses it with their team. Will need Sally's spreadsheet and how projects and issues are named.
SALES-025	Pipeline status updates and chase lists	Not started	Part of the prospect pipeline; built with SALES-024.
SALES-026	Sales activity dashboard	Done	Booked and invoiced by title, issue and month against last year, from the order register and Xero.
SALES-027	Sold work delivery tracking	Done	Each sold item followed through the hand-offs to editorial and production.
SALES-028	Weekly management summary and alerts	Done	
SALES-029	Campaign assembly with booking exclusions	Partly done	"Who should we pitch?" on each issue lists last year's advertisers not yet rebooked, then mail merge sends. Not assembled automatically.
SALES-030	Campaign reply triage	Partly done	Out-of-office, undeliverable and leaver replies are handled (CS-001 to 003). Unsubscribe requests and referrals aren't.
SALES-031	News-triggered sales campaigns	Done	Watches GOV.UK travel advice (and any news feeds added) for selling moments, finds the matching companies in the CRM and drafts the campaign, opened as a mail merge.

SALES-032	Warm non-responder follow-up passes	Done	Ten days after a mail merge, the people who didn't answer get one follow-up drafted, leaving out anyone who replied, booked, bounced or unsubscribed.

Order-to-invoice booking flow

8 automations · 6 done · 2 partly · 0 not started

ID	Automation	Status	Notes
FIN-006	Single booking entry and validation	Done	One booking form for every title, plus online booking forms, with the accounts check.
FIN-007	Order confirmation generation and sending	Partly done	BMI's confirmation in their layout, emailed from the salesperson's Outlook with production and accounts copied. It goes as a Word file; a locked PDF isn't done yet.
FIN-008	Billing details and client billing memory	Partly done	Invoice address and contact kept per booking, filled in from the client's last booking. No VAT number field yet.
FIN-009	Sales order register recording	Done	The register now lives in the app: each booking lands in the right title, issue and month.
FIN-010	Package splitting across issues	Done	Packages split across issues and months, with "to be allocated" items and reminders.
FIN-011	Commission entry creation	Done	Commission worked out from each booking by everyone's plan, with monthly statements.
FIN-012	Invoice raising support in Xero	Done	One click creates a draft invoice in Xero; accounts approve and send it there.
FIN-013	CRM to Xero integration	Done	Invoices and payments sync from Xero and are matched to bookings.

Built beyond the list

Rate cards for every brand, the editorial plan with deadlines, commission plans and statements, costs and profit per edition, invoice reminders and the accounts check, hand-offs to editorial and production, who looks after each client, Act! tools (search on any field, export, bulk update, import, mail merge), and the feedback board and Help Centre.